

Kiran Modi

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G. Brint Ryan College of Business, University of North Texas
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U.S. Work Authorization: H-4 EAD; no employer sponsorship required

Education

2021–2026	Ph.D., Finance, University of North Texas (completed July 2026) Dissertation: <i>Essays on ESG Ratings, Ownership Structure, and Firm Value</i>
2020–2021	M.S., Finance, University of North Texas
2008–2011	Chartered Accountant (CA), Institute of Chartered Accountants of India (ICAI)
2005–2008	B.Com., Gujarat University, India

Research Interests

Corporate Finance; Institutional Investment; Corporate Governance; ESG & Sustainable Finance; Shareholder Agreements; AI/NLP Applications in Finance

Teaching Interests

Corporate Finance; Investments; Financial Markets and Institutions; Financial Statement Analysis; Principles of Finance; Personal Finance

Teaching Experience

Courses Taught as Instructor/Lecturer — University of North Texas

2026–Present	Lecturer (Instructor of Record) AY 2026–27, UNT Denton and UNT Frisco Introduction to Finance (FINA 3770) Financial Markets and Institutions (FINA 4400) Financial Statement Analysis and Liquidity Management (FINA 4300)
2023–2026	Instructor (Instructor of Record) Introduction to Finance (FINA 3770) — 4 courses Financial Statement Analysis and Liquidity Management (FINA 4300)

Instructional Modalities: In-person and online instruction; undergraduate teaching and experience as a graduate teaching assistant.

Graduate Teaching Assistantships (2021–2024)

- Theory & Application of Financial Derivatives (FINA 5220)
- Investment Analysis & Management (FINA 5210)
- Financial Management (FINA 5170)

Undergraduate Teaching Assistantships (2021–2024)

- Introduction to Derivatives (FINA 4210)
- Financial Statement Analysis and Liquidity Management (FINA 4300)
- Introduction to Finance (FINA 3770)

Student Advising and Experiential Learning

2026–Present	Faculty Advisor, Student Investment Group, University of North Texas Mentors students in developing investment questions, evaluating financial and market evidence, assessing assumptions and risk, and presenting defensible investment recommendations.
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Job Market Paper

ESG Ratings, Institutional Rebalancing, and Index Mechanics — *Job Market Paper*

Advanced manuscript; journal submission in preparation.

Studies institutional ownership around MSCI ESG rating changes and index events. Rating upgrades are associated with increased ownership. The negative ownership estimate around ESG ETF deletions becomes statistically insignificant after accounting for concurrent parent-index exits, while the upgrade estimate remains positive and significant. The findings distinguish rating responses from broader benchmark rebalancing.

Working Paper

ESG Ratings, Ownership, and Stock Returns: Cross-Country Analysis

Uses MSCI ESG rating changes and holdings of 2,585 ESG-focused open-end equity funds to examine cross-country ownership and return responses. Matched difference-in-differences estimates show no robust short-run change in aggregate ownership percentage, while downgrades reduce the number of fund holders, especially around the BB eligibility threshold.

Research in Progress

- **Governance by Contract: Shareholder Agreements and Corporate Control** — Solo-authored. Uses SEC EDGAR filings and NLP-assisted clause extraction to construct measures of board representation, voting, transfer, and other contractual control rights not captured by conventional ownership measures. The project examines how contractual rights alter the relationship between cash-flow ownership, voting power, and corporate decisions.

Research Methods, Data and Computing

Methods: Panel-data analysis; difference-in-differences; matching; LP-DiD; event studies and abnormal returns; text analysis and NLP.

Data: Morningstar Direct; WRDS; CRSP/Compustat; MSCI; Bloomberg Terminal; S&P Capital IQ; SEC EDGAR.

Computing: Stata (strong proficiency); R and Python (working knowledge); SAS; LLM-assisted extraction and validation of financial and legal text.

Prior Professional Experience

2011–2017	Principal Chartered Accountant Financial Analyst / Consultant Darshan A Shah & Co., Chartered Accountants, India <i>Conducted financial analysis, financial-statement review, auditing, taxation, and advisory work for business clients, bringing applied accounting and corporate-finance experience to teaching and student mentoring.</i>
2007–2011	Intern Financial Statement Auditing & Taxation Aniket B Shah & Co., Chartered Accountants, India

Selected Awards and Honors

2026	Doctoral Directors Choice Award, FIREL, UNT
2024–2025	Outstanding Student Award, The Ascend Gala, UNT
2023	Best Summer Research Paper Award, FIREL Department, UNT
2022	Best Summer Research Paper Award, FIREL Department, UNT
2020–2021	Outstanding Student Award, The Ascend Gala, UNT

Academic and Professional Service

2026	Southwestern Finance Association (SWFA), Paper Discussant
2024	Financial Management Association (FMA), Paper Discussant

Research Experience

2021–2026	Research Assistant, University of North Texas
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